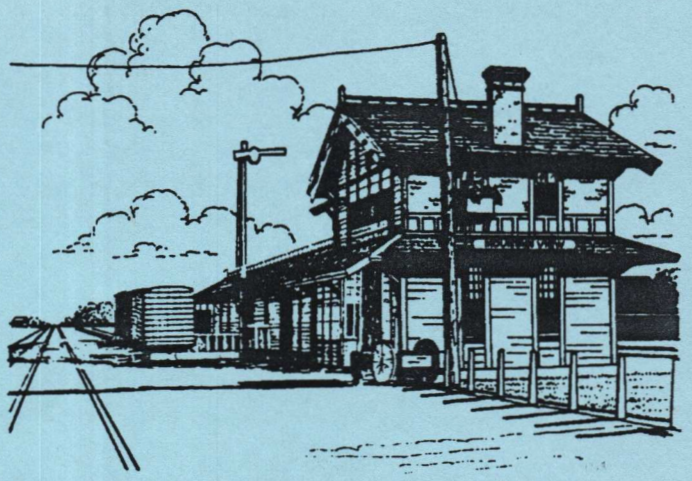
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

Plans for the New Senior & Community Centers
The February Meeting

The next Regular Meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will take place at ***The Adobe Building*** at 2:00 PM, ***Sunday, February 2, 2003.*** Mountain View City Manager Kevin C. Duggan will describe the plans and progress for the new Senior Center and Community Center for the City of Mountain View. Both of the present structures are old, need upgrades to meet current seismic standards and are only marginally able to meet the needs of the residents of the community. Mr. Duggan will bring us up to date on just where the City is headed with these important projects.

Please join us for cake, coffee and fellowship after the presentation.

Centennial Party and Election of Officers
The November Meeting

At the November 3, 2002 Regular Meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association outgoing President Ralph Faravelli was presented with a beautiful tray in recognition of his many services to the Association and the City of Mountain View. In accordance with the bylaws, the Nominating Committee submitted its slate of candidates for election as officers of the Association. A call was made for nominations from the floor, but none were forthcoming. The Nominating Committee's slate was then elected unanimously. The new officers are:

President	***Craig Holden***
Vice President	***Pat Figueroa***
Secretary	***Margaret Peterson***
Treasurer	***Hilton Brown***

The Association had the opportunity to preview the Centennial Video Production outlining the history of Mountain View. We then adjourned to partake of refreshments, including a Centennial Cake.

President's Message from Craig Holden

As the new president of the Mountain View Historical Association, I appreciate the opportunity to become better acquainted with the members of our association. My experience in the MVHA has provided a new realm of sociality for me – new friends, new responsibilities, the fun of working with others on a common project. Being a native of Mountain View, as many of you are, has meant renewing some former acquaintances and friendships. Also, I want to pay tribute to Ralph Faravelli, our outgoing president, for his outstanding service to the MVHA and to our city.

Each of us is profoundly influenced by her/his own family heritage. Events and the lives of people from the past have shaped our present day society. Perhaps this is a simple truth, but this fact is likely at the root of why we are members of MVHA. We are curious about the past history of our city and enjoy the sociality of sharing common values with others who live in Mountain View.

Here are a few items coming up in 2003. By-laws are being revised and you will soon be informed of the changes and can cast your vote. "Milestones," a history of Mountain View, will continue to be sold at various events. Here's an opportunity to volunteer your help. Our August meeting will be our annual Barbeque and Raffle. I look forward to working with the members of our organization in the coming year.

Craig Holden, President, MVHA

Street Talk
By Barbara Kinchen

The November *Street Talk* question was: On early maps Bush Street had a different name. What was it called?

The Answer: On early town maps Bush Street was shown as Live Oak Street.

New Question: In 1892 approximately 250 acres was subdivided and put on the market as Miramonte Subdivision. The original map had roads named Ada, Alice, Gladys, Louise and Stella, said to be named for members of the land owners. What was that family name? This was the same family which gave the land in 1868 for the first Catholic Church in Mountain View. It was situated on El Camino Real near Stevens Creek and was within the later Miramonte Subdivision.

Mountain View Centennial Quiz

Carol Fischer, a Life Member of the Historical Association and the Librarian in charge of the History Center, has been responsible for a regular column in this Newsletter. She either wrote the column herself, or arranged for some other library staff member to write it. Carol passed away in December, but she had written a set of *Centennial Test Questions* which we began publishing in the November issue of this Newsletter. In Carol's memory, the balance of the *Quiz* and the answers are printed below. Carol will be sorely missed.

1. How much did the United States pay for the land that became Moffett Field?
2. What was the plunge? Where was it located?
3. Who donated his land for the establishment of the first Whisman School?
4. How did Eagle Park get its name?
5. What used to occupy the land upon which Fire Station One is built on Shoreline Blvd.?
6. What local landmark once occupied the corner of Castro Street and El Camino Real — the site of today's Washington Mutual Bank?
7. What was NASA originally named when it came to Mountain View in 1939?
8. Who was Mercy Street named after?
9. When was the first Mountain View High School opened and where was it located?
10. How many buildings have carried the name Mountain View High School?
11. Who was the first mayor of Mountain View?
12. When was the first Art and Wine Festival held in Mountain View?
13. Where was Mountain View Airport located?

14. What was the Castro Mound? Where was it located?

15. There was one Ohlone Indian who owned land in this area. Who was he and where was his land located?

16. When was the Mountain View Historical Association incorporated and who was the first president?

17. When was the Mountain View History Center (then known as the Pioneer Room) established?

18. What was the name of the grammar school teacher whose father owned an award-winning vineyard?

19. At one time this Mountain View street was called Pumpkin Alley. Which street had that nickname?

20. The Bank of America (now Red Rock Coffee Co.) At 201 Castro Street was once bombed. Why? By whom.

Answers to the Centennial Questions:

1. The land that became Moffett Field was transferred to the United Sates Navy at a cost of $1.00. Local fund-raising campaigns had raised enough money to pay each of the landowners $450 an acre. That in turn allowed the Santa Clara County Consolidated Air Base Committee to offer the land to the government at such a reasonable price!

2. The plunge, known as the Kingsport Plunge, was the largest open-air salt-water swimming pool in Santa Clara County. It was opened in 1925 and measured 50 feet by 120 feet with a depth of 2 to 9 feet. At night, colored lights illuminate the bottom of the pool. Admission was 10 cents. The plunge was located along the bay on land that is now part of Moffett Field. By the late 1920s, the company had gone bankrupt.

3. Henry Rengstorff donated one acre of his land for the establishment of Whisman School. The one-room school was located on Stierlin Road (now Shoreline Blvd.).

In Commemoration

Carol A. (Westphal) Fischer: — Born in San Francisco, January 27, 1954 to Ethel and Charlie Westphal, died suddenly December 22, 2002 in Mountain View. Carol Fischer is survived by her parents, Ethel and Charlie Westphal of San Francisco, her brother Robert of Marin, her husband Chuck, and three sons Ross, Daniel and Jack. She attended San Francisco State University and San Jose State University and obtained a Masters Degree in Library Science. Mrs Fischer worked for 23 years for the Mountain View Public Library as a reference librarian and overseer of the Library History Center. She was a Life Member of the Mountain View Historical Association and contributed regular columns for the Association Newsletter. In memory of Carol, donations may be made to the MVHA Memorial Fund, P.O. Box 252, Mtn. View, CA 94042. The Memorial Book is located in the History Center at the Mountain View Public Library.

4. Eagle Park was built on land that once served as the athletic fields of Mountain View High School. When the park was dedicated in 1989, it was named in honor of the former school's eagle mascot.

5. The Dana Street School sat on the land now occupied by Fire Station 1 on Shoreline Blvd. The school was built in 1917 and only kindergarten thru third grade children attended class there. The school was condemned in 1955 and razed in 1960.

6. A 52-foot tower and globe was the local landmark that occupied the Castro street and El Camino Real intersection. The globe was part of the Chrysler Exhibit at the world's fair on Treasure Island in San Francisco. Ugo Mancini dismantled the exhibit and brought it to Mountain View in 1940 for the grand opening of his new car showroom. The globe and tower graced that corner until 1974 when the business closed and the familiar sight was demolished.

7. The National Advisory Committee for Aeronautics (NACA) was the original name when Ames was first established in Mountain View in 1939, In 1958 NASA (National Aeronautics and Space Agency) absorbed NACA.

8. Crisanto Castro, who inherited Rancho Pastoria del las Borregas from his father, Mariano, laid out the streets of Mountain View. He named Mercy Street for his youngest daughter, Mercedes. Crisanto also had a sister, Mercedes Castro Calderon. Calderon Avenue is name in honor of this sister and her husband, Andres.

9. The first Mountain View High School was located on El Camino Real at Calderon Avenue. It opened in 1902. Before that time, Mountain View high school students had to travel to Santa Clara or beyond in order to continue their education.

10. There have been three buildings that have used the name Mountain View High School. The first was located on El Camino and Calderon Avenue, built in 1902, razed in 1927. The second was located on Castro Street, built 1923-1924, and razed 1987. The third school is located on Bryant and Truman Avenues. It was formerly called Awalt High School when it was built in 1961. In 1981, it was renamed Mountain View High School when the Castro Street campus closed to high school students.

11. Daniel Benjamin Frink served as Mountain View's first mayor from 1902 until 1904. Mr Frink was born in California in 1857 and died in Mountain View in 1912 For many years he was in the "gent's furnishings goods", notions and hat business on Castro Street. He was married to Mary Alice Hitchcock (died in 1909 at the age of 51) and couple had two sons, Lester and Louis.

12. The first Mountain View Art and Wine Festival was held in 1971. The Chamber of Commerce sponsors the annual event and it is one of the oldest and best attended of any such events in the area.

13. The Mountain View Airport was located at today's San Antonio and Middlefield Roads in 1936. It was owned and operated by Ted Simonic. The airport was closed in the early 1950s and a housing subdivision now occupies the area.

14. The Castro Mound was the name Stanford and University of California archaeologists gave the remains of an Indian village found in the area of today's Central Expressway and San Antonio Road. The mound was discovered and excavated at the turn of the century and was dated back to 760 B.C. The Castro mound was destroyed to make way for housing in the 1940s.

15. Lope Inigo (1781-1864), an Ohlone Indian, was raised at Mission Santa Clara. When he was emancipated in 1839, he moved to the Mountain View area and petitioned the Mexican governor for land. He was granted 1,700 acres that he named Posolmi. This area eventually became Moffett Field. Inigo was married twice but survived both wives. Most of his children didn't live to be adults. By the time of his death, he had sold much of his land and squatters had taken over the rest. It is not known whether he had any survivors.

16. The Mountain View History Pioneer and Historical Association, now the Mountain View Historical Association was founded in 1954. Clarence Taylor served as the first President.

17. The Mountain View History Center, then known as the Pioneer Room, was established in 1967. It was then that the Mountain View Historical Association's collection of artifacts, books, pictures maps and manuscripts was placed in the Mountain View Public Library.

18. Victorine Klein taught grammar school for 32 years. Much of her career was spent at the Dana Street School from which she retired in 1934. Klein School on Ortega Avenue was named in her honor in 1966. The school closed in 1978 and was torn down in 1987. It is now the site of Klein Park. Ms. Klein's father, Pierre (1855-1922) was a native of Alsace, France. In 1888, Mr. Klein purchased 160 acres of land on the Montebello Ridge, approximately in today's Cupertino-Saratoga area. He named his vineyard Mara Valle and raised Cabernet Sauvignon and Cabernet Franc Grapes. In 1895 Mr. Klein won his first medal in Bordeaux, France. This was followed in 1896 by the highest award given at the Brussels Exposition. Finally the Mara Valle vineyard was awarded two gold medals at the 1900 Paris Exposition for its claret and burgundy. These medals are on display in the Mountain View History Center.

19. Calderon Avenue was once nicknamed Pumpkin Alley because of the abundance of pumpkins

grown on this thoroughfare. Calderon Avenue is named for Anders Calderon who was wed to Mariano Castro's daughter, Mercedes. Mr. Calderone, a native of Buenos Aires, Argentina, arrived in California in 1849. The street was laid out in 1886 and because it was smooth and level, horse racing used to occur on the newly excavated road.

20. At 3:00 am on Friday morning, August 19, 1938, Lorenzo (Louis) Cerutti dynamited the Bank of America. The culprit was soon caught and confessed to the crime saying he was getting even for the foreclosure of his home on Center Street. The bank opened as usual Friday morning with damage estimated at $3,000.

Old Newspaper Items Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

100 Years Ago (1902): The local oyster company dredged out its bay beds and people gathered up any oysters which had been overlooked.

Wandering willies and blanket packers (tramps and beggars) gather around the train station.

Several automobiles are being built at the machine shop, which has been in existence for under a year.

The brickyard, just east of town, now has its own railroad stop.

The Ames Building is nearing completion and Parkinson Brothers Lumber and Hardware Company is moving from Olympic Hall into the lower story. A sidewalk has been laid, but problems are predicted as it is six inches lower than the adjoining walk.

New organizations in town: Grange and Patrons of Husbandry.

75 Years Ago (1928): New Year's Day the postoffice moved into its new building on Castro Street at the railroad.

Fire destroyed the Minton Box Factory on Front Street and wiped out $40,000 worth of canned fruit being stored for Clark Canning Company in an adjoining warehouse.

Judge E.L. Maxwell, Justice of the Peace for Fremont Township, resigned to do missionary work in South America. James Atkinson was appointed to fill the unexpired term of office.

A petition went to County Supervisors asking that Grant Road be realigned to run straight north from the foothills to a point just opposite Calderon Avenue.

The new Glumac subdivision, Orchard Park, offers 50 lots between View and Bush Streets, Church Street and the State Highway, a part of the old Ehrhorn orchard.

At Penneys annual January White Sale Penco Sheets, 72 x 99", sold for $1.59 and Wizard pillow cases for 19¢.

Mountain View Union High School showed off the new gym and pool with an open-house for the public, followed by a program and dance.

50 Years Ago (1953): The new eight-room Slater School opened at Gladys Avenue and Whisman Road, bringing an end to double sessions at Highway Elementary School.

City Planner Warren Terriberry has designed a new city seal decal for city automobiles. Blue, red, yellow and black are used in the circular design, which shows an oak tree within a wide valley and a mountain range in the background.

Firemen are busy restoring the 1917 fire truck and it will be featured at a Lions' Club convention in San Francisco.

Knight's Drug Store, 288 Castro Street, was badly damaged when a compressor, running a refrigerator unit, exploded.

Dr. William Wright, Optometrist, has been chosen to head the Mountain View Chamber of Commerce for 1953.

25 Years Ago (1978): Birds, drunk from eating fermented pyracantha berries, have caused problems for years by flying near into cars along Central Expressway near Rengstorff. Spraying to inhibit berry

growth has not been satisfactory, so 800 pyracantha shrubs are being removed.

Water rationing, in effect since April 1977 because of severe drought in California, has been lifted.

Whisman and Mountain View School Districts will again study merger.

Parks and Recreation Department has established a nature study and recreation area, Deer Hollow Farm, on 393 acres, part of the Permanente Creek Preserve.

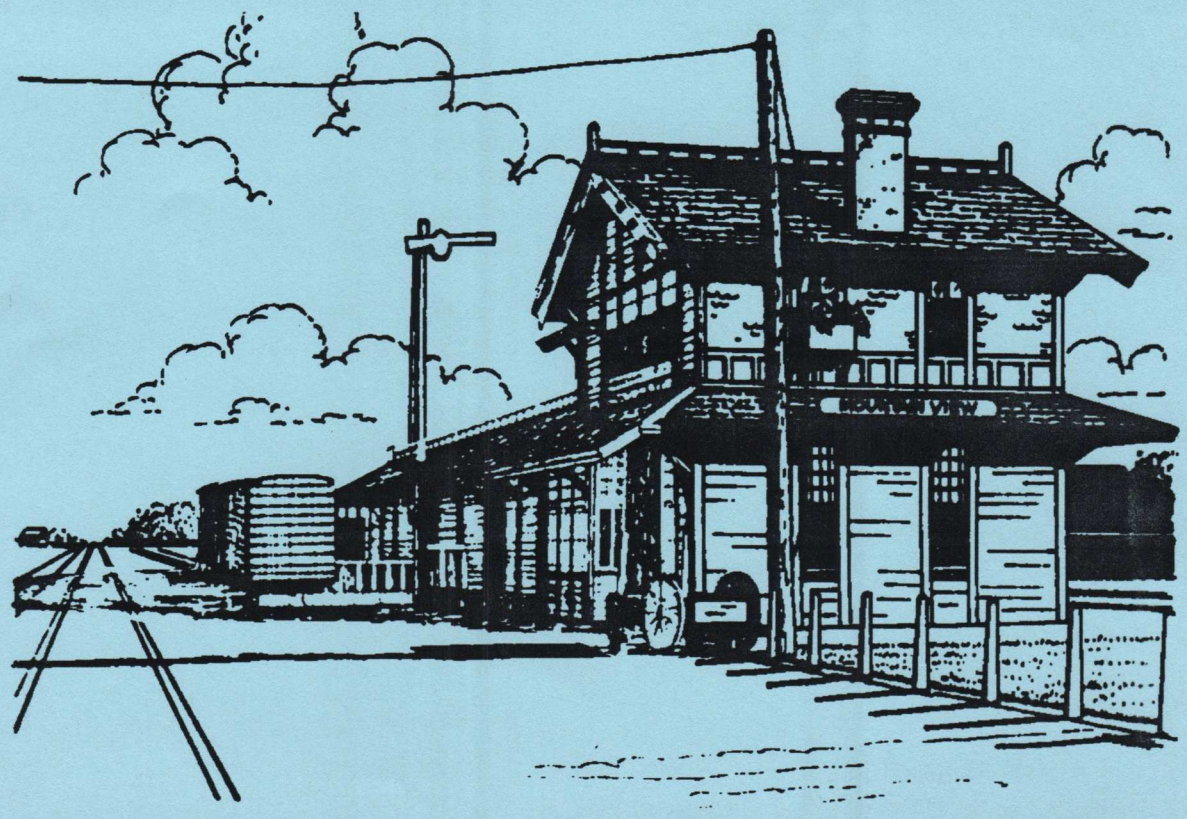
Council turned down a Library Board request for longer open hours on Fridays. The library will be open on Fridays from 2 to 6 p.m., the same hours which went into effect in 1972.

Vandals have five times uprooted newly planted trees between Highway 85 and Stevens Creek, off El Camino Real. Nurseries have donated several hundred trees which city employees have planted and cared for. In the latest incident, approximately 200 trees were torn out, some of which will be salvaged and replanted

.Council's Transportation Committee asked for a study and financing plan to link San Antonio Shopping Center, Old Mill Specialty Center and Mayfield Mall by a shuttle bus system, bicycle lanes and a pedestrian overpass at Central Expressway.

New to the Mountain View History Center by Barbara Kinchen

From Mrs. Jean Gard: Donated three scrapbooks with information about the Quadalco Club – snapshots, newspaper clippings, member directories and program booklets. Quadalco members participated in both civic and social activities. It was started in 1940 as the 20 – 40 (ages) section of the Mountain View Woman's Club. In 1944 it became a separate orgnization known as Quadalco Club.



Southern Pacific Depot

Mountain View, California, built in 1888

Membership Report
June Casey

Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $ 10.00 per year for a family membership. Life memberships are available for $ 100.00 per person.

Life Members	105
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Annual Memberships	392
Total Memberships	499

New Life Members

Jamil Shaikh	Charles S. ThompsonJ. J.
Paul Arata	Marjorie Holden
Jim Spangler	Craig Holden

New Annual Members

Rita Nutile	Lisa Christiansen
Dottie Philpott	David & Tracey Greene
Donald & Loretta Merry	

Association Officers And Executive Committee

President	Craig Holden
Past President & Social	Ralph Faravelli
Vice President	Pat Figueroa
Sergeant At Arms	John Viscovich
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer & Editor	Hilton Brown
Membership	June Casey
Programs and Publicity	Wally Erichsen
Hospitality	Elizabeth Engberg
Memorial/Remembrance	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting.

Life, Honored and Special Members

Honored Member

Chris Castro

Special Member

Lena Alameda

Life Members

O. Lennart Ahlkvist
Mario Ambra
J. Paul Arata
May E. Armanini
John Arrillaga
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Robert J. Bonetti
Flora T. Brown
Hilton U. Brown, III
Laura Withrow Brown
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Alice Churin Carvo
June Casey
William A. Dale
June Redwine de Larios
Cliff Del Carlo
Joseph Diaz
Kevin C. Duggan
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace J. Erichsen
Carmen Faravelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Janice Mae Frankum
Tom Frankum
Laura A. Gentry
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Edward Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
John L. Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Audrey Jarvis Hoke
Craig Holden
Marjorie Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
Harold Jarvis
Al Jehning
Leo E. Kalcic
R. Michael Kasperzak Jr.
Diane M. Keenan
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Barbara Krzyczkowska
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargin Malovos
Thomas E. Miller
Frances Churin Mills
Eva Mockbee
Betty C. Monroe
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Don Newfarmer
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Matt Pear
Richard J. Peery
Harry Pinto
Ida Pinto
Milan Popovich
Massimo Prati
Edward L. Puppo
John P. Puppo
Louis F. Renner
Patricia J. Reyburn
Mark Rogge
Jamil Shaikh
Vivian Schatz
Robert C. Schick
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Margaret Garliepp Sideroff
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Jim Spangler
Martin J. Spangler
Austin Spencer
Honor Spitz
Brigitte Stafford
J. R. Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Jane Culver Stoecklin
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Sally Moore Taboada
H. (Hip) A. Telmont
Charles Thompson
Edna Thompson
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Paula Weaver
Robert Weaver
Denise Williams
Bill Wissel
Lorraine A. Wormald
Mary Lou Zoglin

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
REGULAR MEETING

PLANS FOR THE NEW SENIOR & COMMUNITY CENTERS

BY CITY MANAGER
KEVIN C. DUGGAN

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 2, 2003
2:00 P.M.

THE ADOBE BUILDING
MOFFETT BLVD AND CENTRAL EXPRESSWAY

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____

Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

Make Check Payable to:

Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

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